

1722

YONGZHENG EMPEROR IN CHINA

Yongzheng (1678-1735) became the emperor of China's Qing dynasty in 1722, succeeding his father, Kangxi. He centralized power under the Grand Council and sought to reduce European influence in China, expelling Christian missionaries, banning the sale of opium, and restricting foreign traders to the port of Canton (Guangzhou).



△ The Yongzheng Emperor

1721

VARIOLATION INTRODUCED IN THE WEST

Variolation – in which a small amount of pus from smallpox pustules is placed in cuts in the skin to inoculate against the disease – was a well-known practice in Asia and Africa.

It was introduced to Europe by the British writer Lady Mary Wortley Montagu after she successfully inoculated her own children. Self isolation after inoculation was essential, but many European doctors disregarded this, sending infectious people back into society.



△ Lady Mary Wortley Montagu

1722 Persia's Safavid dynasty is overthrown by Afghan forces under Mahmud Hotak

1724

1724 The Mughal Empire in India further fragments, losing Awadh and Hyderabad to rival dynasties

“A ruler that has but an army has one hand, but he who has a navy has both.”

PETER THE GREAT, c. 1700



1721

PETER THE GREAT BECOMES EMPEROR OF ALL RUSSIA

The founder of modern Russia, Peter (1672-1725) oversaw Russia's transition from tsardom to empire following victory in the Great Northern War. He looked to Western Europe for ideas on modernizing Russia, building St Petersburg, creating the Russian navy, and basing promotion on merit rather than inheritance. Under Peter, Russia became a major power and a threat to the Turkish and Persian empires.

◁ **Peter the Great** on the shore of the Baltic Sea, contemplating the idea of building Petersburg